STUDY AID · MATTHEW 2 · EPISODE 2 OF 58

Jesus Fulfills *the Promise by Moses*

A new Moses, a new Exodus.

▶ Watch on YouTube | Channel: Every Word | 20:00 | LSB references

Full title: Jesus FULFILLS This Promise by Moses! | Ep. 2 (Matthew 2). Series: The Gospel of Matthew Every Word (playlist of 58 videos). Study hub · ← Episode 1 (Matthew 1)

FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND (ADDED) · DEBATED · LSB TEXT

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Summary · Passages · 4 fulfillments · Exodus echoes · People · Map · Terms · Hebrew & Greek · Background · Timeline · Cross-refs · Questions · Application · Copy all notes

01 · FROM THE VIDEO

Short summary

- The teacher reads Matthew 2 aloud: the magi from the east, Herod's secret meeting, the star leading them to the Child, the gifts, the flight to Egypt, Herod's killing of the boys of Bethlehem, and the return to Nazareth.
- He warns against the 'lullaby effect': reading a familiar passage so often

> *"It's like the sound of a thousand padlocks all being opened all at once.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

that we stop thinking about what it says. Read Matthew 2 with fresh eyes.

- Matthew is a Jew writing to Jews, some who follow Jesus and some who do not. He reminds us that Matthew 1 highlighted the outcast, and says chapter 2 tracks along similar lines with Gentile magi coming to worship.
- Matthew points to fulfilled prophecy four times: Micah 5:2, Hosea 11:1, Jeremiah 31:15, and 'He shall be called a Nazarene', which he takes as a loose allusion to the prophets, perhaps Jeremiah 23:5 and Jeremiah 33:15.
- His big idea: Matthew 2 retells the Exodus. A wicked king kills Hebrew boys, God's son comes out of Egypt, a light guides the way, and the chapter heads toward the wilderness. Jesus is the prophet like Moses (Deuteronomy 18:15-18), the new Moses who brings a new Exodus and the new covenant of Jeremiah 31:31-34.

> *"The lullaby effect is when we read something that is so familiar to us we stop thinking deeply about what it's saying.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)



The magi journeying (2:1-2)

James Tissot, The Magi Journeying, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain



They fell down and worshiped (2:11)

Giotto, Adoration of the Magi, 1304-1306, Scrovegni Chapel, Padua. Wikimedia Commons, public domain

Read it as the first hearers did

The original audience knew their Old Testament very well, so the teacher urges us to **listen for the Old Testament** in every line of Matthew 2. He also reminds viewers that in the first century there were Jewish and Gentile disciples, both given room to follow Jesus in their own settings, as Acts 15 shows.

The video reads from another English translation (for example 'wise men'). Quotations on this page are from the LSB ('magi').

02 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

Scripture passages covered

Each link opens the chapter on read.lsbible.org.

Matthew 2:1-12

The visit of the magi: the star, Herod's inquiry, Bethlehem, worship and gifts.

Matthew 2:13-23

The flight to Egypt, Herod's slaughter of the boys, the return and settling in Nazareth.

Micah 5:2

Bethlehem, the ruler's birthplace (quoted in Matthew 2:6). The video also points to the context in Micah 4.

Hosea 11:1

'Out of Egypt I called My son' (quoted in Matthew 2:15).

Jeremiah 31:15, 31-34

Rachel weeping in Ramah (Matthew 2:18), and later in the chapter the promise of a new covenant.

Jeremiah 23:5; 33:15

The righteous Branch of David; the video's suggestion for 'He shall be called a Nazarene.'

Exodus 1:16; 4:22

Pharaoh's order to kill Hebrew sons; 'Israel is My son, My firstborn.'

Deuteronomy 18:15-18

Moses: Yahweh will raise up a prophet like me.

John 6; Matthew 26

The bread of life, and 'Take, eat; this is My body', linked to Bethlehem, 'house of bread.'

Acts 15

Mentioned for how Jewish and Gentile disciples were both welcomed in the early church.

Key verses in the LSB

> “Where is He who has been born King of the Jews? For we saw His star in the east and have come to worship Him.”
>
> Matthew 2:2 (LSB)

> “And after coming into the house they saw the Child with Mary His mother; and they fell to the ground and worshiped Him. Then, opening their treasures, they presented to Him gifts of gold, frankincense, and myrrh.”
>
> Matthew 2:11 (LSB)

“Yahweh your God will raise up for you a prophet like me from among you, from your brothers; you shall listen to him.”

Deuteronomy 18:15 (LSB)

“But this is the covenant which I will cut with the house of Israel after those days, declares Yahweh: I will put My law within them, and on their heart I will write it; and I will be their God, and they shall be My people.”

Jeremiah 31:33 (LSB)

03 · FROM THE VIDEO LSB TEXT

Four padlocks open

Matthew says Scripture was "fulfilled" four times in this chapter. Each lock opens as you scroll: Matthew's words, then the prophet's.

🔓

1. Matthew 2:6 ← Micah 5:2

MATTHEW (LSB)

“And you, Bethlehem, land of Judah, / Are by no means least among the leaders of Judah; / For out of you shall come forth a Leader / Who will shepherd My people Israel.”

MICAH 5:2 (LSB)

“But as for you, Bethlehem Ephrathah, / Too little to be among the clans of Judah, / From you One will go forth for Me to be ruler in Israel. / His goings forth are from everlasting, / From the ancient days.”

The chief priests and scribes answer Herod with this text (2:4-6).

2. Matthew 2:15 ← Hosea 11:1

MATTHEW (LSB)

“Out of Egypt I called My Son.”

HOSEA 11:1 (LSB)

“When Israel was a youth I loved him, / And out of Egypt I called My son.”

In Hosea the 'son' is Israel at the Exodus; Matthew sees Jesus living out Israel's story. The LSB cross-references Exodus 4:22.

3. Matthew 2:18 ← Jeremiah 31:15

MATTHEW (LSB)

“A voice was heard in Ramah, / Weeping and great mourning, / Rachel weeping for her children; / And she was refusing to be comforted, / Because they were no more.”

JEREMIAH 31:15 (LSB)

“Thus says Yahweh, 'A voice is heard in Ramah, / Wailing and bitter weeping. / Rachel is weeping for her children; / She refuses to be comforted for her children / Because they are no more.'”

The video urges reading on in Jeremiah 31: the return (v. 16) and the new covenant (vv. 31-34).

4. Matthew 2:23 ← 'the prophets'

MATTHEW (LSB)

“He shall be called a Nazarene.”

NO SINGLE SOURCE VERSE

No single verse says this. Matthew says 'the prophets' (plural). The video suggests a loose allusion, perhaps to the righteous Branch of Jeremiah 23:5 and 33:15.

See 'Where scholars differ' for the main proposals.

> *“It's like the sound of a thousand padlocks all being opened all at once.*
>
> From the video, on what happens when Jesus appears on the earth

04 · FROM THE VIDEO

Exodus echoes

The video's big idea: Matthew 2 replays Egyptian cruelty, the Exodus and the wilderness. Left: then. Right: now. The last row is an added parallel.

THEN	NOW
THEN · EXODUS 1:16, 22 Pharaoh orders the Hebrew sons put to death: 'if it is a son, then you shall put him to death.'	NOW · MATTHEW 2:16 Herod kills all the male children in Bethlehem and its vicinity, from two years old and under.
THEN · EXODUS 4:22-23 'Israel is My son, My firstborn... Let My son go that he may serve Me.'	NOW · MATTHEW 2:15 'Out of Egypt I called My Son' (quoting Hosea 11:1).
THEN · EXODUS 13:21 Yahweh goes before Israel in a pillar of cloud by day and a pillar of fire by night.	NOW · MATTHEW 2:9 The star 'was going on before them until it came and stood over the place where the Child was.'
THEN · DEUTERONOMY 8:3 Manna in the wilderness: 'man does not live by bread alone.' The video adds that bread also points to the Torah.	NOW · MATTHEW 2:1 Born in Bethlehem, 'house of bread', the One who says 'I am the bread of life' (John 6:35) and 'Take, eat; this is My body' (Matthew 26:26).
THEN · DEUTERONOMY 18:15-18 Moses: 'Yahweh your God will raise up for you a prophet like me.'	NOW · MATTHEW 2-4 Jesus, the new Moses, bringing a new Exodus; next He goes into the wilderness (Matthew 4:1).
THEN · JEREMIAH 31:31-32 'Behold, days are coming... when I will cut a new covenant... not like the covenant which I cut with their fathers in the day I	NOW · MATTHEW 26:28 'This is My blood of the covenant, which is poured out for many for forgiveness of sins.'

took them by the hand to bring them out of the land of Egypt.'

THEN · EXODUS 4:19

Yahweh to Moses in Midian: 'Go, return to Egypt, for all the men who were seeking your life are dead.'

→

NOW · MATTHEW 2:20 ADDED

The angel to Joseph in Egypt: 'go into the land of Israel; for those who sought the Child's life are dead.'

> *He is the new Moses, and if he's the new Moses, guess what, he's bringing forth a new Exodus.*
>
> From the video

05

Key people

What the video says, then a short background note.

The magi

VIDEO Gentiles from the East who track a special, divinely appointed star to worship the new King of the Jews, then are warned in a dream to avoid Herod.

BACKGROUND LSB footnote on 2:1: 'A class of wise men specializing in astronomy, astrology, and natural science.' Matthew does not say how many came; 'three' is a later tradition drawn from the three gifts.

Matthew 2 | Numbers 24

Herod the king

VIDEO A wicked ruler who privately meets the magi so he can find and kill the child; the video calls him a descendant of Esau and not a practicing Jew.

BACKGROUND Herod the Great ruled as Rome's client king of Judea from 37 BC. He was Idumean (Edomite) by descent, and Edom traces back to Esau (Genesis 36:1). He rebuilt the Jerusalem temple on a grand scale.

Genesis 36

Joseph

VIDEO Receives a divine dream warning, takes Mary and Jesus to Egypt, and later brings them back to the land of Israel.

Mary

VIDEO With the Child when the magi arrive and worship.

BACKGROUND Joseph is guided by four dreams in Matthew 1-2 (1:20; 2:13; 2:19; 2:22) and obeys each one at once.

Matthew 1

BACKGROUND Matthew names the Child first each time: 'the Child with Mary His mother' (2:11) and 'the Child and His mother' (2:13, 14, 20, 21).

Luke 2

Chief priests and scribes

VIDEO Herod gathers them to learn where the Christ is to be born.

BACKGROUND They know the answer from Micah 5:2, yet Matthew records no one from Jerusalem going to Bethlehem with the magi.

Micah 5

Archelaus

VIDEO Reigning over Judea in place of Herod, so Joseph is afraid to go there.

BACKGROUND A son of Herod, he ruled Judea, Samaria and Idumea from 4 BC until Rome removed him in AD 6.

Matthew 2

Rachel

VIDEO Pictured weeping for her children in Jeremiah 31:15, quoted at Matthew 2:18.

BACKGROUND Jacob's wife, buried 'on the way to Ephrath (that is, Bethlehem)' (Genesis 35:19). Ramah is the town where Jerusalem's exiles were held before Babylon (Jeremiah 40:1).

Genesis 35 Jeremiah 40

Moses

VIDEO The pattern Matthew is retelling: the prophet who said God would raise up a prophet like him.

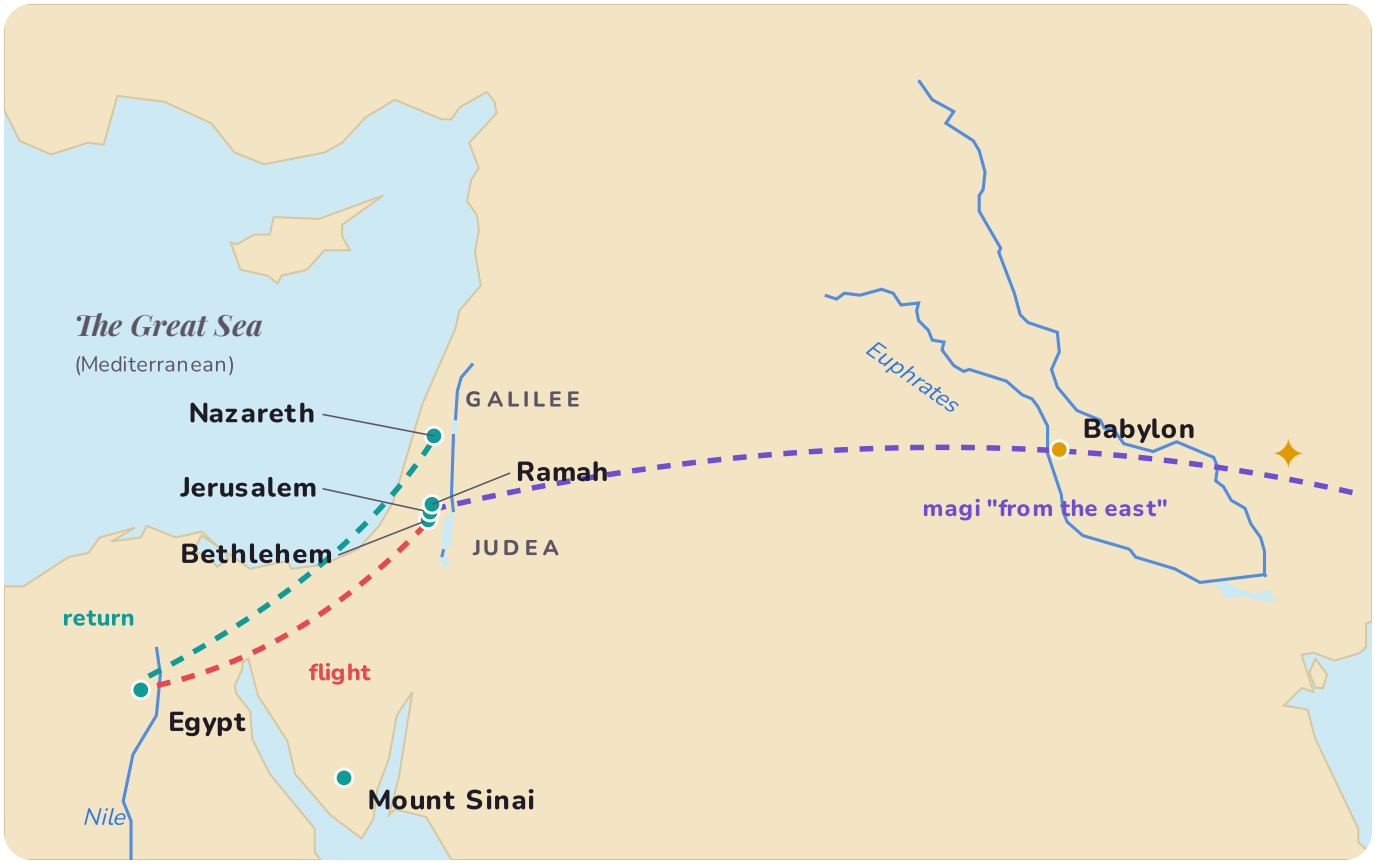
BACKGROUND Moses himself fled from a king who sought to kill him (Exodus 2:15) and was told to return once those seeking his life were dead (Exodus 4:19).

Exodus 2 Deuteronomy 18

06 · BACKGROUND MAP

Where the story moves

Teal pins are places the video mentions; the gold pin is background. Routes are schematic.



Magi's journey (route not given) · Flight to Egypt (2:14) · Return to Nazareth (2:21-23)

Positions approximate. Coastlines and rivers: Natural Earth (public domain). Matthew does not say where in Egypt the family stayed or which road the magi took.

Bethlehem VIDEO
Birthplace of Jesus; 'house of bread' (2:1, 5-6, 16)

Jerusalem VIDEO
Herod's court; the magi ask for the King (2:1-3)

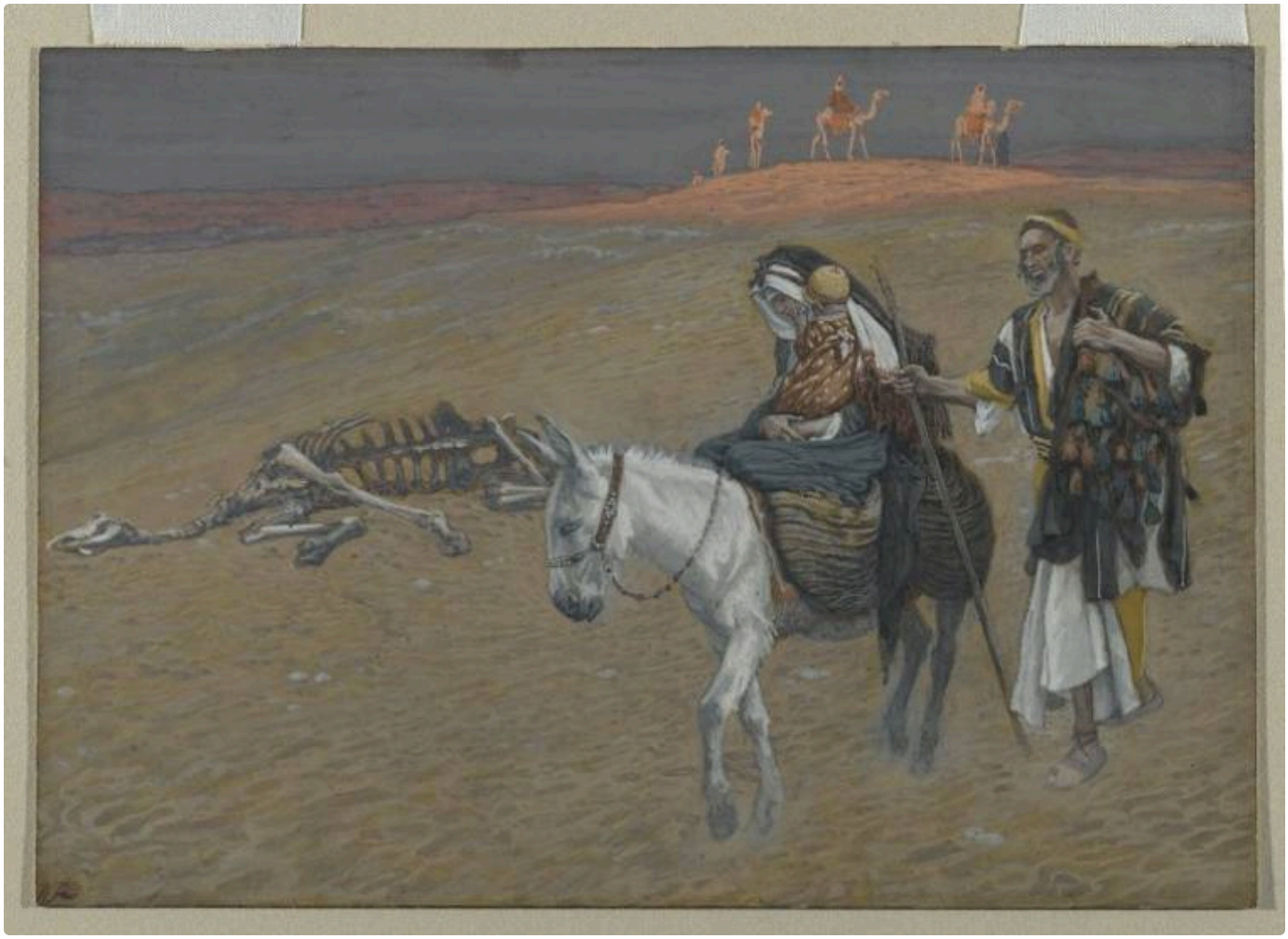
Ramah VIDEO
Rachel weeping (2:18; Jeremiah 31:15)

Nazareth VIDEO
Galilee; the family's home town (2:22-23)

Egypt VIDEO
Refuge until Herod's death (2:13-15)

Mount Sinai VIDEO
The giving of the Law (traditional site; location debated)

Babylon BACKGROUND
One proposed homeland of the magi (debated)



The flight into Egypt (2:14)

James Tissot, The Flight into Egypt, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

07

Key terms

Lullaby effect

VIDEO

The video's name for reading a familiar passage so often that we stop thinking about it. The cure: read with fresh eyes.

Completed Jews

VIDEO

The video's term for Jewish followers of Jesus who still know and revere the Tanakh and obey Torah.

Tanakh / Torah

VIDEO

Exodus motif

VIDEO

Tanakh is the Hebrew Bible (our Old Testament); Torah is the Law, the five books of Moses.

The video's key idea: Matthew 2 replays Egyptian cruelty, the Exodus and the wilderness period.

New covenant

VIDEO

Jeremiah 31:31-34: God's law written on the heart and sins forgiven. The video ties it to the Last Supper.

Magi

BACKGROUND

LSB footnote on 2:1: a class of wise men specializing in astronomy, astrology, and natural science.

Frankincense and myrrh

BACKGROUND

Costly aromatic resins from trees of Arabia and the Horn of Africa. Isaiah 60:6 pictures nations bringing 'gold and frankincense.'

Nazarene

BACKGROUND

Someone from Nazareth, a small Galilean village; see John 1:46, 'Can any good thing come out of Nazareth?'

08 · BACKGROUND

Hebrew and Greek words

The video makes one word point: Bethlehem means "house of bread." The rest are added. Strong's numbers match the LSB's own word tagging for each verse listed.

All | Greek | Hebrew

μάγος

magos G3097

Magus, one of the magi (LSB note: a class of wise men).

Greek · Matt 2:1, 7, 16

ἀστήρ

astēr G792

Star.

Greek · Matt 2:2, 7, 9, 10

προσκυνέω

proskyneō G4352

χρυσός

chrysos G5557

To worship, bow down. The LSB notes 'fell to the ground' in 2:11 as 'Face down in a prone position to indicate worship; lit prostrated.'

Greek · Matt 2:2, 8, 11

Gold.

Greek · Matt 2:11

λίβανος

libanos `G3030`

Frankincense.

Greek · Matt 2:11

σμύρνα

smyrna `G4666`

Myrrh.

Greek · Matt 2:11

Ναζωραῖος

Nazōraios `G3480`

Nazarene, a man of Nazareth.

Greek · Matt 2:23

בֵּית לֶחֶם

Beth Lechem `H1035`

Bethlehem, literally 'house of bread' (the video's point).

Hebrew · Mic 5:2

נֵצֶר

netser `H5342`

Branch, shoot (LSB 'branch'). Often proposed as a wordplay behind 'Nazarene' (debated).

Hebrew · Isa 11:1

צֶמַח

tsemach `H6780`

Branch, sprout (LSB footnote: 'Lit Sprout').

Hebrew · Jer 23:5; 33:15

בְּכוֹר

bekhor `H1060`

Firstborn: 'Israel is My son, My firstborn.'

Hebrew · Exod 4:22

כּוֹכָב

kokhav `H3556`

Star: 'A star shall come forth from Jacob' (an LSB cross-reference for 2:2).

Hebrew · Num 24:17

נָבִיא

navi `H5030`

Prophet: 'a prophet like me.'

Hebrew · Deut 18:15

09

Historical and cultural background

ESTABLISHED

Facts most interpreters agree on

Herod's family and power

Herod the Great was Idumean by descent; the Idumeans were the Edomites, Esau's people (Genesis 36:1). Rome named him king, and he held Jerusalem from 37 BC. Ancient sources describe him as a builder (including the temple) and as ruthless toward rivals, even his own sons.

A visit some time after the birth

By 2:11 the family is in 'the house', and Herod's cut-off is 'two years old and under' based on what the magi told him (2:7, 16). Many interpreters take this to mean the visit came some months after the birth, not the night of it.

Archelaus and Galilee

After Herod died, Archelaus ruled Judea while his brother Herod Antipas ruled Galilee. Archelaus' rule was harsh enough that Rome removed him in AD 6. Luke 2:39 also records the family settling in Nazareth.

Did Matthew write in Hebrew?

The video mentions this view. Papias (early 2nd century, quoted by Eusebius) said Matthew compiled the sayings 'in the Hebrew language.' What Papias meant, and how it relates to our Greek Matthew, is debated.

Jewish and Gentile disciples

The video cites Acts 15. There the Jerusalem council decides 'that we do not trouble those who are turning to God from among the Gentiles' (Acts 15:19 LSB).

DEBATED

Where scholars differ

'He shall be called a Nazarene'

No Old Testament verse says this, and Matthew says 'the prophets.' Main

What was the star?

Proposals include a planetary conjunction, a comet, a nova, or a unique supernatural

proposals: (1) a wordplay on netser, the 'branch' of Isaiah 11:1, with the Branch passages Jeremiah 23:5 and 33:15 (close to the video's view); (2) a link to the Nazirite (Judges 13:5); (3) a summary of prophecies that the Messiah would be despised, since Nazareth was looked down on (John 1:46). The views can overlap.

light. Matthew says it went before them and stood over the place where the Child was (2:9), which many take as more than an ordinary star. Numbers 24:17 is an LSB cross-reference.

Where were the magi from?

Matthew says only 'from the east.' Persia, Babylon (with its long tradition of star-watching and a large Jewish community) and Arabia (the gifts; Isaiah 60:6) are all proposed.

Dates

Herod's death is usually dated 4 BC, so Jesus' birth is often placed about 6-4 BC. A minority argue Herod died in 1 BC. The date of the Exodus (c. 1446 or the 1260s BC) is also debated.

CAREFUL READING

Small slips in the video

- The video once says 'Jeremiah 31:1'; the verse Matthew quotes is Jeremiah 31:15, which the video names later.
- The video places 'He shall be called a Nazarene' at Matthew 2:22; it is Matthew 2:23.
- The video describes Herod killing 'male firstborns'; Matthew 2:16 says 'all the male children... from two years old and under.'
- In one spot the video says Joseph hid 'from Pharaoh'; Matthew 2:13 has Herod. The slip shows how strongly the teacher hears the Exodus in the story.

10 · BACKGROUND

From the Exodus to Nazareth

Coral dots mark where Matthew 2 quotes or echoes the event. Early dates are approximate; dates tagged debated vary among scholars.

PATRIARCHAL ERA

Rachel dies on the way to Ephrath (Bethlehem); Esau's line becomes Edom

Genesis 35-36

c. 1446 or 1260s BC DEBATED

Pharaoh kills Hebrew sons; Moses flees and returns; Israel, God's firstborn son, comes out of Egypt

Exodus 1-4 *Echo: Matthew 2:13-20*

Wilderness period

Pillar of cloud and fire; manna; Balaam's 'star from Jacob'; Moses promises a prophet like him

Deuteronomy 18

8th century BC

Hosea: 'out of Egypt I called My son'; Micah: a ruler from Bethlehem

Micah 5 *Quoted: Matthew 2:6, 15*

c. 586 BC

Exiles gathered at Ramah; Jeremiah's comfort and the promise of a new covenant

Jeremiah 31 *Quoted: Matthew 2:18*

37 BC

Herod the Great takes Jerusalem and rules as king of Judea

Matthew 2

c. 6-4 BC DEBATED

Jesus born in Bethlehem; the magi come; the flight to Egypt

Matthew 2 *Matthew 2:1-15*

4 BC (usual date) DEBATED

Herod dies; Archelaus rules Judea; the family settles in Nazareth

Matthew 2 *Matthew 2:19-23*

AD 6

Rome removes Archelaus

Luke 2

11

Cross-references

LSB cross-references come from the LSB's own margin for Matthew 2; the rest are added.

Micah 5:2; Luke 2:4-7
Born in Bethlehem (for 2:1)
LSB CROSS-REF

Jeremiah 23:5; Zechariah 9:9; John 1:49
The King of Israel (for 2:2)
LSB CROSS-REF

Numbers 24:17
'A star shall come forth from Jacob' (for 2:2, 7)
LSB CROSS-REF

John 7:42
The Christ comes from Bethlehem, David's village (for 2:5-6)
LSB CROSS-REF

Matthew 14:33
The disciples also worship Him (for 2:11)
LSB CROSS-REF

Hosea 11:1; Numbers 24:8; Exodus 4:22
God's son out of Egypt (for 2:15)
LSB CROSS-REF

Jeremiah 31:15
Rachel weeping (for 2:18)
LSB CROSS-REF

Luke 2:39; John 1:45-46
Nazareth (for 2:23)
LSB CROSS-REF

Isaiah 60:3, 6; Psalm 72:10-11
Nations and kings bring gifts to the King
ADDED

Exodus 4:19
'Those seeking your life are dead' (compare 2:20)
ADDED

Jeremiah 31:31-34; Hebrews 8:8-12
The new covenant
ADDED

Matthew 28:19
'Make disciples of all the nations'
ADDED

12

Reflection and discussion

1 Fight the lullaby effect: read Matthew 2 slowly, out loud if you can. Which detail

had you been reading past without noticing?

2 Compare Exodus 1:15-22, 2:15 and 4:19 with Matthew 2:13-20. Which parallels stand out, and what would they have told Matthew's Jewish hearers about Jesus?

3 Gentile magi travel far to worship, while Herod is troubled 'and all Jerusalem with him' (Matthew 2:3). The scribes knew the right verse but did not go. What makes the difference between knowing Scripture and responding to the King?

4 Read all of Jeremiah 31. How does the hope that follows Rachel's weeping (Jeremiah 31:16-17, 31-34) shape the way you read Matthew 2:18?

5 The video's assignment: what promises has God made to the nations (for example Genesis 12:3; Isaiah 60:3), and how does Jesus fulfill them for you? What will you do about it this week?

13

Application

FROM THE VIDEO

The video's lesson for the original audience: Jesus' birth is not just the story of a savior born in a dramatic moment. It is the fulfillment of many promises God made to His people. Jesus is the prophet like Moses, the new Moses bringing a new Exodus and the new covenant. The same lesson is posed to us: if Jesus fulfills God's promises to Israel, He also fulfills God's promises to

STUDY NOTE (ADDED)

Matthew 2 opens with Gentiles from the east worshiping the King of the Jews (Matthew 2:2, 11), an early picture of the nations coming to His light (Isaiah 60:3). The Gospel ends with the risen Jesus sending His disciples to 'make disciples of all the nations' (Matthew 28:19). The promise to Abraham that 'in you all the families of the earth will be blessed' (Genesis 12:3) is kept in Jesus.

us all, so learn what God has promised the nations. The teacher asks each viewer to work out the lesson for their own life and to decide what to do about it.

> *If Jesus is the fulfillment of promises that God has made to the Israelites, that means he is also the fulfillment of promises that God makes to us all.*
>
> From the video

14 · EXPORT

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